

How to Create a New PostgreSQL Database in Docker (WSL)

Step 0 — Make sure Docker PostgreSQL is running

```
docker ps
```

Look for your Postgres container:

```
postgres:15 ... PORTS: 0.0.0.0:5432->5432/tcp ... NAMES: postgres_db
```

If it's not running, start it:

```
docker start postgres_db
```

Step 1 — Connect to PostgreSQL using an existing database

Since your new database doesn't exist yet, connect to an existing database (sales_db, postgres, or template1):

```
psql -h localhost -p 5432 -U admin -d sales_db
```

- User: admin

- Password: admin123

You should see:

```
sales_db=#
```

Step 2 — Create the new database

Inside the psql prompt:

```
CREATE DATABASE new_database_name;
```

Example:

```
CREATE DATABASE dbt_ecommerce_db;
```

PostgreSQL should reply:

```
CREATE DATABASE
```

Step 3 — Connect to the new database

```
\c dbt_ecommerce_db
```

You will see:

You are now connected to database "dbt_ecommerce_db".

```
dbt_ecommerce_db=#
```

Step 4 — Verify the new database exists

```
\l
```

You should see all databases, including your new one.

Step 5 — Exit psql

```
\q
```

Step 6 — Reconnect directly to the new database in the future

```
psql -h localhost -p 5432 -U admin -d dbt_ecommerce_db
```

Password: admin123

Quick Reference Summary

1. Check PostgreSQL container: `docker ps`
2. Connect to existing DB: `psql -h localhost -p 5432 -U admin -d sales_db`
3. Create new DB: `CREATE DATABASE your_new_db;`
4. Connect to new DB: `\c your_new_db`
5. Verify: `\l`
6. Exit: `\q`
7. Future connections: `psql -h localhost -p 5432 -U admin -d your_new_db`